

Yorkshire Pudding — The Science-First Version

No raising agent — just steam. A thin rested batter into smoking-hot fat, a fierce oven, and a door you do not open.

Yield: 12 (standard tin) Active: 10 min Total: 1 hr Oven: 230–220°C Done: deep gold, 4" up

WHERE IT WAS BORN "Dripping pudding" of northern England, set under the spit to catch the fat. Named <i>Yorkshire pudding</i> by Hannah Glasse, 1747. Thrift: served first, with gravy, to fill bellies before the costly meat.	EATEN, AUTHENTICALLY The Sunday roast's right hand — beef and dark gravy poured into the hollow. Traditionally a first course, sometimes sweet with syrup for afters.	HOW IT'S USED NOW Roast partner; giant bowl Yorkshires for stew; <i>toad in the hole</i> over sausages; the popover and Dutch baby are its cousins.
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INGREDIENTS

12 PUDDINGS · WEIGHT

BATTER

Eggs (~4 large, RT)	200g 4 large
Bread flour (strong, 12–13%)	200g 1⅞ cups
Whole milk	150g ⅝ cup
Water (crisper than all milk)	50g 3⅓ tbsp
Fine sea salt	4g ⅔ tsp

FOR THE TIN

Beef dripping (or goose fat / oil)	60g ¼ cup
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THE RATIO — EQUAL PARTS, BY WEIGHT
Egg 100% · Flour 100% · Liquid 100% · Salt 2%. Equal weights of egg, flour and liquid — a thin batter the texture of single cream. The high liquid is the point: more water, more steam, more rise.

Kit: 12-hole metal tin (or popover/muffin tin) · whisk · scale · jug · oven that holds a true 230°C

METHOD

- Mix & rest.** Whisk 200g eggs + 4g salt; whisk in 200g flour to a smooth paste; loosen with 150g milk + 50g water to a thin single-cream batter. Rest **30 min** (or overnight, fridge).
Resting hydrates the flour, relaxes gluten and settles bubbles — higher, more even rise. — McGee 2004
- Smoke the fat.** 5g dripping per hole. Oven **230°C (450°F)**; heat the tin inside until the fat shimmers and just smokes (~10 min).
The batter must hit fat hot enough to flash to steam and sear the base; lukewarm fat = greasy and sunken. — McGee; López-Alt
- Fill fast.** Pour cold batter into the smoking fat, each hole **~halfway**. It should sizzle. Straight back in.
Cold batter into hot fat = maximum thermal shock = maximum rise. Don't overfill. — López-Alt
- Bake, no peeking.** **220–230°C, 20–25 min**, until towering, deep gold, crisp. **Do not open the oven.**
Opening drops the temperature; if the walls haven't set, the steam condenses and they collapse. — McGee 2004

Done: risen 2–3× the tin, deep golden, crisp-walled, hollow centre. **Serve at once** — they are steam, and they sink as they cool. Gravy at the table, not before.

Time it to the roast — the only live step is the bake (make the batter the day before; it rises better for the wait). Start the puddings as the joint comes out to rest: ~25 min in, they land hot for carving.

ONE BATTER, TWO DISHES — TOAD IN THE HOLE

Brown **8 sausages** in the dripping in the hot tin (5–6 min). Fat smoking, pour the batter **around** them, bake **220°C, 30–35 min** to risen and deep gold — no peeking. Onion gravy. *Same batter, one tray, supper.*

ELEVATION		
TIER 1 — NO EXTRA TIME	TIER 2 — WORTH IT	TIER 3 — SERVICE
Thyme / mustard / horseradish — whisked into the batter All-milk batter — richer, more tender Overnight rest — the easiest height gain there is	Goose / duck fat — deeper savour, crisper shell Giant bowl Yorkshires — one big tin, 30–35 min Toad in the hole — same batter over sausages	Edible bowl for stew or bangers & mash Dutch baby — sweet, lemon & sugar Mini canapé — rare beef & horseradish

TROUBLESHOOT

Didn't rise	Fat not smoking / oven cool / batter thick → smoke the fat, true 230°C, thin to single cream
Rose then sank	Oven opened / pulled early → door shut; bake to deep gold and rigid
Greasy base	Fat not hot enough → it must sizzle on contact
Dense, tough	Overmixed / unrested / too thick → mix smooth, then rest 30 min
Sank on the plate	Served too slow → plate the second they're out

CHARTER PREP & STORAGE

Batter ahead	Rest up to 24 h at 4°C — rises better; whisk before filling
Time to roast	Start as the joint rests; ~25 min → hot for carving
Re-crisp	3–4 min at 220°C — never the microwave
Frozen baked	1 mo; crisp from frozen, 5 min at 220°C
On a swell	Fill in the galley, slide in just before plating